

COMPARISON · SPLIT · STRUCTURE

split-compare

Two options + verdict — dark frame on the left, 2-column option grid + a recommendation card on the right.

DECISION REQUIRED

Build the data layer or buy it?

Both paths are viable. The difference is where we spend the next 18 months.

BUILD IN-HOUSE

- Full control over schema and roadmap
- 2-3 engineer-quarters to reach feature parity
- Ongoing maintenance burden stays internal

BUY + CONFIGURE

- Ship in 6 weeks, not 9 months
- Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features
- Exit risk manageable — data export contractually guaranteed

RECOMMENDATION

Buy the infrastructure. Build the differentiation. Revisit in 24 months.

DECISION REQUIRED

Build the data layer or buy it?

Both paths are viable. The difference is where we spend the next 18 months.

BUILD IN-HOUSE

- Full control over schema and roadmap
- 2-3 engineer-quarters to reach feature parity
- Ongoing maintenance burden stays internal

BUY + CONFIGURE

- Ship in 6 weeks, not 9 months
- Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features
- Exit risk manageable — data export contractually guaranteed

RECOMMENDATION

Buy the infrastructure. Build the differentiation. Revisit in 24 months.

DECISION REQUIRED

Build the data layer or buy it?

Both paths are viable. The difference is where we spend the next 18 months.

BUILD IN-HOUSE

- Full control over schema and roadmap
- 2-3 engineer-quarters to reach feature parity
- Ongoing maintenance burden stays internal

BUY + CONFIGURE

- Ship in 6 weeks, not 9 months
- Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features
- Exit risk manageable — data export contractually guaranteed

RECOMMENDATION

Buy the infrastructure. Build the differentiation. Revisit in 24 months.

DECISION REQUIRED

Build the data layer or buy it?

Both paths are viable. The difference is where we spend the next 18 months.

BUILD IN-HOUSE

- Full control over schema and roadmap
- 2-3 engineer-quarters to reach feature parity
- Ongoing maintenance burden stays internal

BUY + CONFIGURE

- Ship in 6 weeks, not 9 months
- Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features
- Exit risk manageable — data export contractually guaranteed

RECOMMENDATION

Buy the infrastructure. Build the differentiation. Revisit in 24 months.

When NOT to reach for split-compare.

Three or more options. split-compare is strictly two — first card is the alternative, second card is the preferred. For three options, use `verdict-grid` or `decision` successive slides.

No verdict. The blockquote is mandatory. Without it the slide collapses to a comparison without a call — use `compare-prose` for that case.

Preferred on the left. Layout convention pins the preferred option to the second (right) card. Putting the recommendation first breaks the reading flow and the accent badge lands on the wrong card.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`compare-prose` — the comparison is undecided — no verdict bar yet

`decision` — the verdict slide that follows a separate comparison

`split-panel` — the right side is findings, not paired options

`verdict-grid` — three or more options scored against shared criteria